

# Connecticut State Department of Education

## DISTRICT PROFILE AND PERFORMANCE REPORT FOR SCHOOL YEAR 2022-23



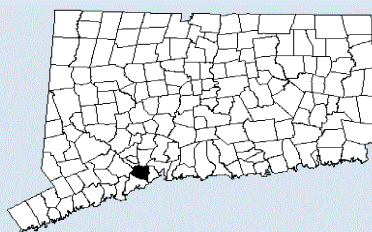
### Orange School District

Dr. Vince Scarpetti, Superintendent • 203-891-8020 • <http://www.oess.org>

#### District Information

|                                     |              |
|-------------------------------------|--------------|
| Grade Range                         | PK-6         |
| Number of Schools/Programs          | 4            |
| Enrollment                          | 1,281        |
| Per Pupil Expenditures <sup>1</sup> | \$18,246     |
| Total Expenditures <sup>1</sup>     | \$23,172,973 |

<sup>1</sup> Expenditure data reflect the 2021-22 school year.



#### Community Information

AdvanceCT Town Profiles provide summary demographic and economic information for Connecticut's municipalities at <https://www.advancect.org/site-selection/town-profiles>

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#### Notes

Unless otherwise noted, all data are for 2022-23 and include all grades offered by the district.

In most tables, data are displayed only for the three major race/ethnicity categories. For additional race/ethnicity categories, please visit <https://edsight.ct.gov>

State totals are not displayed as they are not comparable to district totals.

Special Education tables reflect only students for whom the district is fiscally responsible.

\* When an asterisk is displayed, data have been suppressed to safeguard student confidentiality. Complete data suppression guidelines are available at <https://tinyurl.com/SuppressionPolicy>

N/A is displayed when a category is not applicable for a district or school.

#### Students

##### October 1, 2022 Enrollment<sup>2</sup>

|                                           | Count | District<br>Percent of Total<br>(%) | State<br>Percent of Total<br>(%) |
|-------------------------------------------|-------|-------------------------------------|----------------------------------|
| Female                                    | *     | *                                   | 48.4                             |
| Male                                      | 653   | 51.0                                | 51.5                             |
| Non-Binary                                | *     | *                                   | 0.1                              |
| American Indian or Alaska Native          | *     | *                                   | 0.3                              |
| Asian                                     | 168   | 13.1                                | 5.2                              |
| Black or African American                 | 29    | 2.3                                 | 12.5                             |
| Hispanic or Latino of any race            | 93    | 7.3                                 | 30.0                             |
| Native Hawaiian or Other Pacific Islander | *     | *                                   | 0.1                              |
| Two or More Races                         | 66    | 5.2                                 | 4.5                              |
| White                                     | 923   | 72.1                                | 47.5                             |
| English Learners/Multilingual Learners    | 75    | 5.9                                 | 9.7                              |
| Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals  | 157   | 12.3                                | 42.4                             |
| Students with Disabilities <sup>3</sup>   | 143   | 11.2                                | 17.1                             |

<sup>2</sup> This table represents students in grades PK-12 reported by the district in the Public School Information System (i.e., PSIS Reporting District).

<sup>3</sup> Students in this category are students with an individualized education program (IEP) only. This category does not include students with Section 504 plans or services plans.

##### Chronic Absenteeism and Suspension/Expulsion

|                                          | Chronic Absenteeism <sup>4</sup> |          | Suspension/Expulsion <sup>5</sup> |          |
|------------------------------------------|----------------------------------|----------|-----------------------------------|----------|
|                                          | Count                            | Rate (%) | Count                             | Rate (%) |
| Female                                   | 30                               | 5.0      | *                                 | *        |
| Male                                     | 55                               | 8.7      | *                                 | *        |
| Non-Binary                               | 0                                | *        | 0                                 | *        |
| Black or African American                | *                                | *        | 0                                 | 0.0      |
| Hispanic or Latino of any race           | 12                               | 12.4     | *                                 | *        |
| White                                    | 57                               | 6.5      | 8                                 | 0.8      |
| English Learners/Multilingual Learners   | 14                               | 17.3     | *                                 | *        |
| Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals | 21                               | 13.1     | *                                 | *        |
| Students with Disabilities               | 12                               | 9.2      | *                                 | *        |
| District                                 | 85                               | 6.9      | 12                                | 0.9      |
| State                                    |                                  | 20.0     |                                   | 7        |

**Number of students qualified as truant under state statute: 87**

**Number of school-based arrests: 0**

<sup>4</sup> A student is chronically absent if they miss ten percent or greater of the total number of days enrolled in the school year for any reason. Pre-Kindergarten students are excluded from this calculation.

<sup>5</sup> This column displays the count and percentage of students who receive at least one in-school suspension, out-of-school suspension or expulsion.

# District Profile and Performance Report for School Year 2022-23

## Orange School District

### Educators

#### Full-Time Equivalent (FTE)<sup>1</sup> Staff

|                                                           | FTE  |
|-----------------------------------------------------------|------|
| <b>General Education</b>                                  |      |
| Teachers and Instructors                                  | 89.5 |
| Paraprofessional Instructional Assistants                 | 33.6 |
| <b>Special Education</b>                                  |      |
| Teachers and Instructors                                  | 12.0 |
| Paraprofessional Instructional Assistants                 | 31.0 |
| <b>Administrators, Coordinators and Department Chairs</b> |      |
| District Central Office                                   | 5.0  |
| School Level                                              | 4.0  |
| <b>Library/Media</b>                                      |      |
| Specialists (Certified)                                   | 2.0  |
| Support Staff                                             | 0.0  |
| Instructional Specialists Who Support Teachers            | 5.5  |
| Counselors, Social Workers and School Psychologists       | 5.0  |
| School Nurses                                             | 4.0  |
| Other Staff Providing Non-Instructional Services/Support  | 75.5 |

<sup>1</sup> In the full-time equivalent count, staff members working part-time in the school are counted as a fraction of full-time. For example, a teacher who works half-time in a school contributes 0.50 to the school's staff count.

#### Educators by Race/Ethnicity

|                                           | Count | District<br>Percent of Total<br>(%) | State<br>Percent of Total<br>(%) |
|-------------------------------------------|-------|-------------------------------------|----------------------------------|
| American Indian or Alaska Native          | 1     | 0.8                                 | 0.1                              |
| Asian                                     | 0     | 0.0                                 | 1.3                              |
| Black or African American                 | 1     | 0.8                                 | 4.6                              |
| Hispanic or Latino of any race            | 2     | 1.6                                 | 4.9                              |
| Native Hawaiian or Other Pacific Islander | 0     | 0.0                                 | 0.1                              |
| Two or More Races                         | 0     | 0.0                                 | 0.2                              |
| White                                     | 118   | 95.9                                | 88.7                             |

#### Classroom Teacher Attendance: 2021-22

|                                                                   | District | State |
|-------------------------------------------------------------------|----------|-------|
| Average Number of FTE Days Absent Due to Illness or Personal Time | 12.8     | 13.2  |

### Instruction and Resources

#### Students Who Spend 80% or Greater Time with Nondisabled Peers<sup>2</sup>

|                            | Count | Rate (%) |
|----------------------------|-------|----------|
| Autism                     | 7     | 35.0     |
| Emotional Disability       | N/A   | N/A      |
| Intellectual Disability    | 0     | 0        |
| Learning Disability        | 28    | 71.8     |
| Other Health Impairment    | 21    | 70.0     |
| Other Disabilities         | N/A   | N/A      |
| Speech/Language Impairment | 21    | 80.8     |
| District                   | 77    | 66.4     |
| State                      |       | 68.6     |

<sup>2</sup> This table represents students ages 6-21 for whom the district is fiscally responsible (i.e., Nexus District students with an IEP or services plan).

# District Profile and Performance Report for School Year 2022-23

## Orange School District

### Students with Disabilities by Primary Disability<sup>1</sup>

|                            | District |          | State    |
|----------------------------|----------|----------|----------|
|                            | Count    | Rate (%) | Rate (%) |
| Autism                     | 24       | 1.9      | 2.4      |
| Emotional Disability       | 0        | 0.0      | 1.0      |
| Intellectual Disability    | *        | *        | 0.6      |
| Learning Disability        | 39       | 3.2      | 6.3      |
| Other Health Impairment    | 30       | 2.4      | 3.4      |
| Other Disabilities         | *        | *        | 1.1      |
| Speech/Language Impairment | 31       | 2.5      | 1.9      |
| All Disabilities           | 129      | 10.5     | 16.7     |

<sup>1</sup> This table represents students in grades K-12 for whom the district is fiscally responsible (i.e., Nexus District students with an IEP or services plan).

### Students with Disabilities Placed Outside of the District<sup>2</sup>

|                                   | District |          | State    |
|-----------------------------------|----------|----------|----------|
|                                   | Count    | Rate (%) | Rate (%) |
| Public Schools in Other Districts | *        | *        | 8.1      |
| Private Schools or Other Settings | *        | *        | 4.7      |

<sup>2</sup> This table represents students in grades K-12 for whom the district is fiscally responsible (i.e., Nexus District students with an IEP or services plan).

### Overall Expenditures<sup>3</sup>: 2021-22

|                                                | Total (\$)   | Per Pupil     |            |
|------------------------------------------------|--------------|---------------|------------|
|                                                |              | District (\$) | State (\$) |
| Instruction                                    | \$13,211,738 | \$10,403      | \$12,671   |
| Support services - students                    | \$3,942,084  | \$3,139       | \$1,558    |
| Support services - instruction                 | \$997,841    | \$794         | \$837      |
| Support services - general administration      | \$714,062    | \$569         | \$463      |
| Support services - school based administration | \$990,681    | \$789         | \$1,133    |
| Central and other support services             | \$225,631    | \$180         | \$716      |
| Operation and maintenance of plant             | \$1,906,685  | \$1,518       | \$1,893    |
| Student transportation services                | \$1,184,252  | \$980         | \$1,464    |
| Food services                                  | .            | .             | \$5        |
| Enterprise operations                          | .            | .             | \$186      |
| Total                                          | \$23,172,973 | \$18,246      | \$20,165   |

<sup>3</sup> Expenditures may be supported by local tax revenues, state grants, federal grants, municipal in-kind services, tuition and other sources.

### Special Education Expenditures: 2021-22

|                                                          | District    |                      | State                |
|----------------------------------------------------------|-------------|----------------------|----------------------|
|                                                          | Total (\$)  | Percent of Total (%) | Percent of Total (%) |
| Teacher Salaries                                         | \$2,167,649 | 43.8                 | 29.0                 |
| Instructional Aide Salaries                              | .           | .                    | 10.6                 |
| Other Salaries                                           | \$960,954   | 19.4                 | 10.1                 |
| Employee Benefits                                        | \$631,466   | 12.8                 | 13.1                 |
| Purchased Services Other Than Transportation             | \$212,479   | 4.3                  | 5.9                  |
| Special Education Tuition                                | \$346,346   | 7.0                  | 21.8                 |
| Supplies                                                 | \$27,747    | 0.6                  | 0.7                  |
| Property Services                                        | .           | .                    | 0.4                  |
| Purchased Services For Transportation                    | \$332,954   | 6.7                  | 8.1                  |
| Equipment                                                | \$263,739   | 5.3                  | 0.2                  |
| All Other Expenditures                                   | \$6,600     | 0.1                  | 0.1                  |
| Total                                                    | \$4,949,934 | 100.0                | 100.0                |
| Percent of Total Expenditures Used for Special Education |             | 21.4                 | 24.9                 |

### Expenditures by Revenue Source<sup>4</sup>: 2021-22

|                 | Percent of Total (%) Excluding School Construction |
|-----------------|----------------------------------------------------|
| Local           | 94.2                                               |
| State           | 3.4                                                |
| Federal         | 2.4                                                |
| Tuition & Other | .                                                  |

<sup>4</sup> Revenue sources do not include state-funded Teachers' Retirement Board contributions, Connecticut Technical Education and Career System (CTECS) operations, CSDE-budgeted costs for salaries and leadership activities and other state-funded school districts (e.g., Dept. of Children and Families and Dept. of Correction).

# District Profile and Performance Report for School Year 2022-23

## Orange School District

### Performance and Accountability

#### District Performance Index (DPI)

A District Performance Index (DPI) is the average performance of students in a subject area (i.e., ELA, Mathematics or Science) on the state summative assessments. The DPI ranges from 0-100. A DPI is reported for all students tested in a district and for students in each individual student group. Connecticut's ultimate target for a DPI is 75.

|                                                | English Language Arts (ELA) |      | Math  |      | Science |      |
|------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------|------|-------|------|---------|------|
|                                                | Count                       | DPI  | Count | DPI  | Count   | DPI  |
| American Indian or Alaska Native               | 0                           | N/A  | 0     | N/A  | 0       | N/A  |
| Asian                                          | 103                         | 86.5 | 103   | 85.8 | 25      | 87.3 |
| Black or African American                      | *                           | *    | *     | *    | *       | *    |
| Hispanic or Latino of any race                 | 53                          | 65.1 | 53    | 56.5 | 17      | *    |
| Native Hawaiian or Other Pacific Islander      | *                           | *    | *     | *    | *       | *    |
| Two or More Races                              | 43                          | 86.1 | 43    | 79.7 | 12      | *    |
| White                                          | 489                         | 76.2 | 489   | 72.6 | 113     | 72.4 |
| English Learners/Multilingual Learners         | 60                          | 66.4 | 60    | 63.2 | 19      | *    |
| Non-English Learners/Non-Multilingual Learners | 646                         | 78.3 | 646   | 74.4 | 153     | 75.4 |
| Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals       | 86                          | 70.0 | 86    | 66.1 | 17      | *    |
| Not Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals   | 620                         | 78.3 | 620   | 74.4 | 155     | 74.1 |
| Students with Disabilities                     | 75                          | 52.8 | 76    | 47.1 | 19      | *    |
| Students without Disabilities                  | 631                         | 80.2 | 630   | 76.6 | 153     | 76.1 |
| High Needs                                     | 175                         | 64.6 | 176   | 59.6 | 43      | 56.3 |
| Non-High Needs                                 | 531                         | 81.5 | 530   | 78.0 | 129     | 78.8 |
| District                                       | 706                         | 77.3 | 706   | 73.4 | 172     | 73.2 |

#### National Assessment of Educational Progress (NAEP): Percent At or Above Proficient<sup>1</sup>

|                 | NAEP 2022 |         | NAEP 2013 |
|-----------------|-----------|---------|-----------|
|                 | Grade 4   | Grade 8 | Grade 12  |
| <b>READING</b>  |           |         |           |
| Connecticut     | 35        | 35      | 50        |
| National Public | 32        | 29      | 36        |
| <b>MATH</b>     |           |         |           |
| Connecticut     | 37        | 30      | 32        |
| National Public | 35        | 26      | 25        |

<sup>1</sup> NAEP is often called the "Nation's Report Card." It is sponsored by the U.S. Department of Education. This table compares Connecticut's performance to that of national public school students. Performance standards for state assessments and NAEP are set independently. Therefore, one should not expect performance results to be the same across Smarter Balanced and NAEP. Instead, NAEP results are meant to complement other state assessment data. To view performance on NAEP by student group, at [https://portal.ct.gov/-/media/SDE/Student-Assessment/NAEP/report-card\\_NAEP-2022.pdf](https://portal.ct.gov/-/media/SDE/Student-Assessment/NAEP/report-card_NAEP-2022.pdf)

#### Physical Fitness Tests: Students Reaching Health Standard<sup>2</sup>

|                      | Percent of Students by Grade <sup>3</sup> (%) |      |      |      | All Tested Grades |          |
|----------------------|-----------------------------------------------|------|------|------|-------------------|----------|
|                      | 4                                             | 6    | 8    | HS   | Count             | Rate (%) |
| Sit & Reach          | 85.5                                          | 79.5 | N/A  | N/A  | 355               | 82.3     |
| Curl Up              | 83.5                                          | 86.8 | N/A  | N/A  | 353               | 85.3     |
| Push Up              | 69.5                                          | 66.7 | N/A  | N/A  | 353               | 68.0     |
| Mile Run/PACER       | 77.8                                          | 74.6 | N/A  | N/A  | 351               | 76.1     |
| All Tests - District | 54.0                                          | 52.1 | N/A  | N/A  | 349               | 53.0     |
| All Tests - State    | 51.5                                          | 46.0 | 44.1 | 41.1 |                   | 45.5     |

<sup>2</sup>The Connecticut Physical Fitness Assessment (CPFA) is administered to students in Grades 4, 6, 8 and High School (HS). The health-related fitness scores gathered through the CPFA should be used to educate and motivate children and their families to increase physical activity and develop lifetime fitness habits.

<sup>3</sup>Only students assessed in all four areas are included in this calculation.

# District Profile and Performance Report for School Year 2022-23

## Orange School District

### Next Generation Accountability Results

Connecticut's Next Generation Accountability System is a broad set of 12 indicators that help tell the story of how well a district/school is preparing its students for success in college, careers, and life. It moves beyond test scores and graduation rates to provide a more holistic, multifactor perspective of district and school performance.

| Indicator                                                 |                     | Index/Rate    | Target | Points Earned | Max Points | % Points Earned | State Average Index/Rate |
|-----------------------------------------------------------|---------------------|---------------|--------|---------------|------------|-----------------|--------------------------|
| ELA Performance Index                                     | All Students        | 77.3          | 75     | 50.0          | 50         | 100.0           | 63.9                     |
|                                                           | High Needs Students | 64.6          | 75     | 43.1          | 50         | 86.2            | 54.1                     |
| Math Performance Index                                    | All Students        | 73.4          | 75     | 48.9          | 50         | 97.9            | 59.7                     |
|                                                           | High Needs Students | 59.6          | 75     | 39.7          | 50         | 79.4            | 48.9                     |
| Science Performance Index                                 | All Students        | 73.2          | 75     | 48.8          | 50         | 97.5            | 61.6                     |
|                                                           | High Needs Students | 56.3          | 75     | 37.5          | 50         | 75.0            | 51.1                     |
| ELA Academic Growth                                       | All Students        | 69.6%         | 100%   | 69.6          | 100        | 69.6            | 57.2%                    |
|                                                           | High Needs Students | 61.2%         | 100%   | 61.2          | 100        | 61.2            | 52.5%                    |
| Math Academic Growth                                      | All Students        | 75.6%         | 100%   | 75.6          | 100        | 75.6            | 61.8%                    |
|                                                           | High Needs Students | 63.8%         | 100%   | 63.8          | 100        | 63.8            | 55.5%                    |
| Progress Toward English Proficiency                       | Literacy            | 67.2%         | 100%   | 33.6          | 50         | 67.2            | 55.3%                    |
|                                                           | Oral                | 62.2%         | 100%   | 31.1          | 50         | 62.2            | 56.1%                    |
| Chronic Absenteeism                                       | All Students        | 6.9%          | <=5%   | 46.2          | 50         | 92.4            | 20.0%                    |
|                                                           | High Needs Students | 11.9%         | <=5%   | 36.2          | 50         | 72.3            | 28.5%                    |
| Preparation for CCR                                       | % Taking Courses    | .             | 75%    | .             | .          | .               | 90.4%                    |
|                                                           | % Meeting Benchmark | .             | 75%    | .             | .          | .               | 44.3%                    |
| On-track to High School Graduation                        |                     | .             | 94%    | .             | .          | .               | 82.4%                    |
| 4-year Graduation All Students (2022 Cohort)              |                     | .             | 94%    | .             | .          | .               | 88.9%                    |
| 6-year Graduation - High Needs Students (2020 Cohort)     |                     | .             | 94%    | .             | .          | .               | 85.6%                    |
| Postsecondary Entrance (Class of 2022)                    |                     | .             | 75%    | .             | .          | .               | 66.1%                    |
| Physical Fitness (estimated part rate) and (fitness rate) |                     | 98.0%   53.0% | 75%    | 35.3          | 50         | 70.7            | 93.0%   45.5%            |
| Arts Access                                               |                     | .             | 60%    | .             | .          | .               | 54.5%                    |
| <b>Accountability Index</b>                               |                     |               |        | <b>720.5</b>  | <b>950</b> | <b>75.8</b>     |                          |

NOTE: A dot (.) appears in the table above when there are fewer than 20 students in the student group or the indicator is not applicable based on grades served.

| Gap Indicators                | Non-High Needs Rate <sup>1</sup> | High Needs Rate | Size of Gap | State Gap Mean +1 Stdev <sup>2</sup> | Is Gap an Outlier? <sup>2</sup> |
|-------------------------------|----------------------------------|-----------------|-------------|--------------------------------------|---------------------------------|
| Achievement Gap Size Outlier? |                                  |                 |             |                                      | Y                               |
| ELA Performance Index Gap     | 75.0                             | 64.6            | 10.4        | 16.6                                 |                                 |
| Math Performance Index Gap    | 75.0                             | 59.6            | 15.4        | 18.0                                 |                                 |
| Science Performance Index Gap | 75.0                             | 56.3            | 18.7        | 17.8                                 |                                 |
| Graduation Rate Gap           | .                                | .               | .           | .                                    |                                 |

<sup>1</sup>If the Non-High Needs Rate exceeds the ultimate target (75 for Performance Index and 94% for graduation rate), the ultimate target is used for gap calculations.

<sup>2</sup>If the size of the gap exceeds the state mean gap plus one standard deviation, the gap is an outlier.

NOTE: A dot (.) appears in the table above when there are fewer than 20 students in at least one of the student groups used to calculate the gap measure or the indicator is not applicable based on grades served. Gap calculations are based on unrounded rates.

| Subject/Student Group |                     | Participation Rate (%) <sup>3</sup> |
|-----------------------|---------------------|-------------------------------------|
| ELA                   | All Students        | 99.3                                |
|                       | High Needs Students | 98.4                                |
| Math                  | All Students        | 99.3                                |
|                       | High Needs Students | 98.9                                |
| Science               | All Students        | 99.4                                |
|                       | High Needs Students | 97.8                                |

<sup>3</sup>Minimum participation standard is 95%.

### Connecticut's State Identified Measurable Result (SIMR) for Children with Disabilities

Increase the reading performance of all 3rd grade students with disabilities statewide, as measured by Connecticut's English Language Arts (ELA) Performance Index.

Grade 3 ELA Performance Index for Students with Disabilities:

**District: 52.0**

**State: 49.6**

# District Profile and Performance Report for School Year 2022-23

## Orange School District

### Narratives

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#### School District Improvement Plans and Parental Outreach Activities

The Orange Board of Education, administration, and staff consider communication with parents vitally important towards ensuring the children of Orange are successful learners. Our district relies on several communication channels to support parents. One of these is a website that offers a wealth of information about each school, upcoming activities, teacher webpages, policies, and so much more. Another channel is Alert Solutions. Our district uses this system to send out weekly newsletters/e-blasts and regular communication to families. In addition, staff newsletters and announcements regarding information about upcoming activities and district news are sent home weekly. Regularly-scheduled parent conferences are also held throughout the year to promote effective communication regarding progress and student needs. Standards-based grading and reporting, progress reports, student assessment, and early intervention reports all contribute to our communication efforts. We believe these specific communication channels enable parents to initiate discussions that support authentic, life-long learning. To further create a collaborative community of learners, workshops and on-line video resources are offered throughout the school year to help parents understand curriculum connections, assessments, intervention strategies, technology resources, and alternate ways of supporting and reinforcing learning at home. Resources, such as Newsela, Freckle, digital books, Lexia Core 5, Greg Tang Math (and others), are made available to students for home use to support and enhance learning.

In addition, several flexible, student choice-driven, and differentiated in-person summer learning opportunities have been provided to all families. These include core academic subjects at all levels, art, yoga, physical education, camp invention, Lego STEM, and martial arts to name a few.

The Orange Public School PTA/PTOs are also dedicated and involved groups of parents and teachers who work together to provide outstanding educational experiences for Orange students. Members of the PTA/PTO Cultural Arts committees provide monthly cultural experiences for our children to promote the arts and encourage the celebration of diversity while meeting curriculum standards. Other family-oriented activities to facilitate parent involvement are STEM Night, Drama Club, Math Night, Literacy Night, Parent Volunteer Programs, School Beautification, and BOE meetings.

#### Efforts to Reduce Racial, Ethnic and Economic Isolation

Orange Leadership Teams and PTO/As are committed to providing experiences that guide students and staff to celebrate differences, interact peacefully, and demonstrate compassion. These efforts are fostered through regular meetings where experiences are discussed and created. Staff and student participation in the myriad of experiences created by PTO/A and Leadership Team members, reduce racial, ethnic, economic, and gender isolation.

The Orange Elementary School staff embed and integrate relevant resources to increase awareness of and sensitivity to diversity in the curriculum. As a result, meaningful and contextualized opportunities to learn about prejudice, compassion and tolerance are created. These efforts are supported regularly and consistently by our library media specialists, who include current books and resources which represent people from all walks of life in various settings, fields, positions, and careers in the collections they update.

In addition, students in Orange study a world language--Spanish. As a result, Orange students are immersed weekly in the language and culture of Hispanic people. Moreover, collaborative initiatives between special and general education departments expand students' understanding of children with significant disabilities. Grants from the Anti-Defamation League to train students on how to be allies and to work to eliminate exclusion and isolation among peers are also available.

Social-emotional learning (SEL) through the RULER approach, developed by researchers and educators from the Yale Center of Emotional Intelligence (Recognizing, Understanding, Labeling, Expressing and Regulating), and understanding adverse, childhood experiences (ACES), in addition to learning about restorative practices and healthy school climates. Each school for example, focuses on creating a climate where respect is emphasized and celebrated. Individual classrooms focus on pillars of character through classroom lessons, circle time, and morning meetings. Finally, economic isolation is ameliorated with grant support (Titles I, II, III, IV, ESSER I, 2 & ARP ESSER) and participation in the Open Choice Program.

# District Profile and Performance Report for School Year 2022-23

## Orange School District

### **Equitable Allocation of Resources among District Schools**

The first pathway designed to ensure all Orange students have access to equitable resources is to provide every student with an opportunity to engage with a viable curricula aligned to Connecticut standards. Orange educators rely on contemporary curricular concepts to create real-world learning experiences that eliminate redundancy without compromising scientifically-based practices or findings from the learning sciences. Defining and identifying conditions for success is another critical pathway. Effective Tier 1 instruction, supported by effective scientific research-based interventions (SRBI), embedded in a comprehensive and balanced assessment system, result in accurate diagnosis and prescription for guaranteed student growth.